

Enterprise AI Hiring Platform

MVP Product Requirements Document & 12-Week Roadmap

Product thesis

Convert role context into structured, explainable candidate evidence using resume intelligence and an AI-led voice screening interview - while keeping final hiring authority with authorised humans.

Prepared for

Cofounder review and MVP execution alignment

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Decision requested

Approve the MVP boundaries, 12-week execution plan, pilot strategy and human-in-the-loop product position. Founder decisions that can materially change the plan are consolidated in Section 16.

Executive decision summary

CPTO recommendation

Build a focused enterprise screening layer - not a full ATS. The launch wedge is role-context creation, evidence-grounded resume assessment, LLM-designed AI voice screening, explainable shortlisting and enterprise governance.

12 weeks MVP to enterprise pilot	8 modules Focused launch scope	2 partners Target design partners	100-250 Pilot candidates
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What we are building

An enterprise hiring intelligence platform that helps recruitment teams define a role correctly, evaluate candidates consistently and run scalable AI-led voice screens. It produces evidence-backed recommendations and a complete audit trail for human review.

What we are not building

- A full applicant tracking system or onboarding suite.
- An autonomous rejection engine.
- Voice, face, emotion, accent, age, gender or personality inference.
- Uncontrolled agents that contact, score or reject candidates outside approved workflows.

Founder-level decisions

Decision	Recommended default	Why it matters
Initial segment	Mid-to-senior technology, fintech and BFSI hiring in India	Strong founder credibility, high cost of poor screening and enterprise willingness to pay.
Product position	Decision-support and evidence platform	Reduces brand, legal and buyer trust risk versus autonomous hiring claims.
Interview mode	Browser-based voice first; video optional later	Fastest path to natural screening without facial-analysis risk.
Deployment	Multi-tenant SaaS with dedicated tenant option later	Supports speed while keeping enterprise architecture extensible.
Integrations	CSV, API and webhooks in MVP	Avoids losing the roadmap to ATS-specific integrations.
Languages	English first; Hindi/Hinglish after pilot evidence	Controls speech quality and evaluation complexity during launch.

Document map

Section	Purpose
1. Product vision and strategic thesis	Why this product should exist and how it wins
2. Users, jobs and target market	Who the MVP serves and the highest-value workflows
3. Product principles and scope	Guardrails, in-scope modules and explicit exclusions
4. End-to-end product workflow	The complete recruiter, hiring manager and candidate journey
5. Functional requirements	Detailed requirements for all eight MVP modules
6. AI voice screening specification	Interview design, runtime behaviour, evaluation and candidate safeguards
7. AI and enterprise architecture	Agent boundaries, model strategy, services and data design
8. Security, privacy and Responsible AI	Controls required for enterprise trust and brand preservation
9. Non-functional requirements	Reliability, performance, accessibility, supportability and cost controls
10. Metrics and evaluation	Product, business, AI quality and governance KPIs
11. Twelve-week roadmap	Build sequence, demonstrations, dependencies and decision gates
12. Team, cost and operating model	Lean resourcing and execution discipline
13. Risks and mitigations	Material product, AI, delivery and go-to-market risks
14. Launch acceptance criteria	Objective gates for pilot and production readiness
15. Post-MVP roadmap	What follows only after product-market evidence
16. Cofounder decisions and next actions	Items to approve and actions for the next ten working days

1. Product vision and strategic thesis

Vision

Make enterprise hiring decisions faster, more consistent and more defensible by turning role requirements and candidate conversations into structured evidence.

The problem

- Job descriptions rarely capture the actual outcomes, trade-offs and evidence required for success.
- Resume screening overweights keywords, pedigree and formatting while underweighting verified experience and context.
- First-round interviews consume recruiter time, vary widely between interviewers and often fail to validate resume claims.
- Hiring teams struggle to explain why one candidate progressed and another did not.
- Generic AI screening can create brand damage when it is opaque, intrusive or falsely positioned as objective.

Strategic wedge

Where we win

We connect role-context design, resume evidence and an adaptive voice interview in one governed workflow. The output is not a black-box score; it is an evidence map, confidence level, risks and recommended next action.

Human-controlled hiring intelligence workflow



AI structures evidence and recommends next actions; authorised users retain final decision authority.

Business hypothesis

Hypothesis	How MVP tests it
Recruiters will pay to reduce screening effort without giving up control.	Measure recruiter time saved, candidates processed per recruiter and human override patterns.
Hiring managers value better role definition and evidence more than a generic fit score.	Measure scorecard approval, shortlist acceptance and usefulness ratings by criterion.
Candidates will complete AI voice screens when disclosure, usability and fallback options are clear.	Measure completion, drop-off, support requests, retry requests and candidate satisfaction.
Enterprise buyers require governance features at pilot stage, not after scale.	Make RBAC, audit, retention and model-version traceability launch gates.

CUSTOMER

2. Users, jobs and target market

Primary target segment

India-based enterprises and growth companies hiring mid-to-senior white-collar talent, initially concentrating on technology, product, data, fintech and BFSI roles where domain context and claim validation matter more than high-volume keyword filtering.

Core personas

Persona	Primary job to be done	MVP value
Recruiter / Talent Partner	Screen more candidates consistently and surface the strongest evidence quickly.	Structured resume review, AI voice screen, prioritised work queue and explainable recommendation.
Hiring Manager	Translate an imperfect JD into the outcomes and evidence that define success.	Role Context Studio, weighted scorecard, interview approval and candidate comparison.
Talent Acquisition Leader	Improve speed and quality while controlling process, compliance and candidate experience.	Workspace governance, analytics, audit, templates and policy controls.
Candidate	Demonstrate relevant experience fairly without repetitive scheduling and screening calls.	Clear disclosure, flexible voice interview, pause/retry and evidence-focused evaluation.
Enterprise Admin / Auditor	Control access, retention, model changes and decision traceability.	RBAC, audit logs, policy configuration, exports and incident visibility.

MVP jobs-to-be-done

- When a new role opens, help the hiring manager turn the JD and business context into an approved scorecard in less than 30 minutes.
- When resumes arrive, identify evidence, gaps and claims requiring verification without inventing facts.
- When first-round screening capacity is constrained, conduct a consistent AI voice interview that adapts to the candidate resume and role.
- When reviewing candidates, show the evidence behind each assessment and what remains uncertain.
- When a decision is challenged, reconstruct the role rubric, questions, model version, evidence and human actions used at that time.

Pilot boundaries

Dimension	Pilot assumption
Design partners	Two enterprise partners or one paying enterprise customer
Roles	Three to five roles
Candidates	100-250 total
Role types	Technology, product, data, risk, sales or operations; mid-to-senior levels
Language	English
Interview duration	30-45 minutes
Decision authority	Human-only final advance/reject decision

SCOPE

3. Product principles and MVP scope

Product principles

Principle	Implementation meaning
Evidence over intuition	Every material assessment must link to resume or interview evidence, or be explicitly marked as missing evidence.
Structured before adaptive	All candidates receive common competency coverage; adaptation is bounded and cannot silently change the rubric.
Human authority	AI can recommend, prioritise and flag. Authorised humans control progression and rejection.
Candidate dignity	No facial, emotional, accent, personality or deception inference. Clear disclosure and accommodation routes are mandatory.
Governance by design	Tenant isolation, access controls, auditability, retention and model traceability are part of the MVP.
Provider flexibility	Voice, speech-to-text and LLM providers are abstracted behind service contracts and evaluation gates.
Cost-aware quality	Use smaller or deterministic components where they meet quality thresholds; reserve larger models for high-value reasoning.

MVP modules

#	Module	Launch capability
1	Enterprise Workspace	Organisation setup, users, roles, permissions and tenant-level policies.
2	Role Context Studio	JD ingestion, hiring-manager context, competency rubric, weights and approval.
3	Candidate Intelligence	Resume parsing, timeline, claims, evidence, gaps, eligibility and ranking support.
4	Interview Design Studio	LLM-designed common, behavioural, scenario and resume-validation questions.
5	AI Voice Interview	Browser voice interview, adaptive probes, transcript, recovery and candidate controls.
6	Evaluation Engine	Criterion scores, evidence, confidence, contradictions, risk flags and next-step recommendation.

#	Module	Launch capability
7	Decision Workspace	Candidate comparison, notes, reviewer collaboration, override and final disposition.
8	Governance Centre	Audit events, model/prompt versions, consent, retention, monitoring and exports.

Explicitly out of scope for MVP

- Full ATS, career site, payroll, background verification and onboarding.
- Autonomous sourcing, candidate outreach or rejection.
- Video or facial analysis, emotion recognition, voice biometrics, deception detection or personality inference.
- Social-media scraping or external enrichment without an approved enterprise data source.
- Native integrations with every ATS; only CSV, REST API and webhooks initially.
- Mass-market hourly hiring, campus assessment centres and coding-test proctoring.
- Fine-tuning proprietary models before evaluation data demonstrates a clear need.

EXPERIENCE

4. End-to-end product workflow

Recruiter and hiring-manager workflow

Step	Expected behaviour
1. Create role	Upload JD or start from template; add outcomes, constraints, must-haves and preferences.
2. Approve success profile	Review competencies, evidence anchors, weights, disqualifiers and interview coverage.
3. Ingest candidates	Upload resumes or accept API/CSV feed; deduplicate and validate file quality.
4. Review resume evidence	See criterion-level evidence, gaps, contradictions and suggested verification topics.
5. Approve interview plan	Review common core questions and policy-bounded candidate-specific probes.
6. Invite candidates	Send branded invitation with disclosure, consent, microphone test and support options.
7. Run AI voice screen	Conduct 30-45 minute conversation with recovery, pause and bounded follow-ups.
8. Review evidence report	Compare resume and interview evidence, confidence, risks and unanswered items.
9. Human disposition	Advance, hold, request further assessment or reject with a recorded human rationale.
10. Learn and monitor	Capture overrides, hiring-manager feedback and interview-quality signals for evaluation.

Candidate workflow

1. Open a branded invitation page with role, company, expected duration and AI-use disclosure.
2. Provide consent, choose accessibility or human-support options and run a microphone/network test.
3. Complete the voice interview with visible progress, repeat/clarify controls and clear failure recovery.
4. Review the transcript summary or flag transcription errors before final submission where configured.
5. Receive completion confirmation, privacy information and a channel to report technical or fairness concerns.

Brand-preservation rule

A failed connection, speech-recognition issue, accommodation need or candidate complaint must never silently lower the candidate score. Such events create a review flag and operational workflow.

5. Functional requirements

5.1 Enterprise Workspace

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance signal
FR-101	Create an organisation workspace with configurable branding, domains and policy defaults.	Must	Admin can configure and preview workspace before inviting users.
FR-102	Support Recruiter, Hiring Manager, Admin and Auditor roles with least-privilege permissions.	Must	Permission tests prevent unauthorised role, candidate and audit access.
FR-103	Isolate all tenant data and include tenant context in every service request and audit event.	Must	Cross-tenant automated security tests pass.
FR-104	Allow role-level assignment of recruiters and hiring managers.	Must	Unassigned users cannot see candidate details.
FR-105	Expose tenant policies for retention, audio storage, candidate transcript review and human override.	Should	Policy changes are versioned and applied to new sessions.

5.2 Role Context Studio

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance signal
FR-201	Ingest a JD and extract title, level, outcomes, skills, experience, location and constraints.	Must	User can edit every extracted field before approval.
FR-202	Capture structured hiring-manager inputs: first-90-day outcomes, critical decisions, failure modes and evidence of success.	Must	Approved role contains at least one measurable outcome and one evidence anchor per critical competency.
FR-203	Generate a weighted scorecard with must-have, preferred and non-evaluated criteria.	Must	Weights total 100%; mandatory criteria are explicit.
FR-204	Generate structured interview competencies and behavioural anchors.	Must	Every scored question maps to an approved criterion.
FR-205	Version and lock the rubric once candidate screening starts.	Must	Changes require a new version and preserve historical evaluations.
FR-206	Allow approved templates by role family and seniority.	Should	Template reuse does not overwrite role-specific context.

5.3 Candidate Intelligence

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance signal
FR-301	Accept PDF/DOCX resumes and validate file type, malware status and parse quality.	Must	Unsupported or low-quality files enter a manual-review state.
FR-302	Extract employment timeline, roles, skills, projects, education, outcomes and quantified claims.	Must	Each extracted claim links to source text and page where available.
FR-303	Map resume evidence to role criteria without filling missing evidence by inference.	Must	Unsupported conclusions are blocked or labelled missing.
FR-304	Identify timeline inconsistencies, overlapping roles and claims requiring interview verification.	Should	Flags are descriptive, not accusations.
FR-305	Provide criterion-level relevance, evidence strength and confidence.	Must	Reviewer can open the source evidence behind each assessment.
FR-306	Deduplicate candidates within a tenant.	Should	Potential duplicates require human confirmation before merge.

5.4 Interview Design Studio

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance signal
FR-401	Generate a common core interview covering approved role competencies.	Must	Coverage report shows every mandatory criterion.
FR-402	Generate candidate-specific questions from resume claims, gaps and contradictions.	Must	Every question shows its source claim and purpose.
FR-403	Generate scenario and behavioural questions with scoring anchors.	Must	Questions are job-related and avoid protected or sensitive topics.
FR-404	Allow recruiters to edit, approve, reject or lock questions.	Must	Only approved interview plans can be launched.
FR-405	Set time budget, maximum probes, prohibited topics and question order flexibility.	Must	Runtime orchestrator enforces policy configuration.
FR-406	Run automated question-quality checks before approval.	Should	Checks cover relevance, duplication, ambiguity, bias risk and unsupported assumptions.

5.5 AI Voice Interview

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance signal
FR-501	Provide browser-based realtime voice interview with microphone and network pre-check.	Must	Supported browsers complete test flow without recruiter assistance.
FR-502	Present disclosure, consent, estimated duration and support/accommodation routes.	Must	Interview cannot start until required consent is recorded.
FR-503	Ask approved core questions and bounded adaptive probes.	Must	Runtime logs show no unapproved topic or probe-limit breach.
FR-504	Handle silence, interruption, clarification, repetition and candidate questions politely.	Must	Conversation test suite meets defined success thresholds.
FR-505	Recover from transient network/provider failures without penalising the candidate.	Must	Session resumes from a safe checkpoint or routes to support.
FR-506	Generate timestamped transcript with confidence and uncertainty markers.	Must	Low-confidence segments are visibly flagged for review.
FR-507	Support pause, reschedule, retry request and human alternative.	Must	Operational state is logged and never converted into a low candidate score.
FR-508	Do not evaluate non-job-related vocal characteristics.	Must	Evaluation schema contains no accent, emotion, pitch, age, gender, personality or deception field.

5.6 Evaluation and Explainability

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance signal
FR-601	Evaluate each approved criterion using resume and interview evidence.	Must	Every score has supporting evidence or is marked insufficient evidence.
FR-602	Separate evidence strength, criterion score and model confidence.	Must	UI shows the distinction and does not collapse them into one opaque number.
FR-603	Identify contradictions between resume and interview without alleging dishonesty.	Should	Flag language is neutral and requests human verification.
FR-604	Generate recommendation: Strong Review, Review, Further Assessment or Insufficient Data.	Must	No autonomous Reject recommendation in MVP.
FR-605	Run a second-pass grounding and policy check before publishing the report.	Must	Unsupported or prohibited content blocks report release.

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance signal
FR-606	Show model, prompt, rubric and interview-plan versions.	Must	Reviewer can reconstruct the evaluation configuration.

5.7 Recruiter Decision Workspace

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance signal
FR-701	Provide candidate list with filters for evidence, status, confidence and review flags.	Must	Recruiter can create a prioritised review queue.
FR-702	Provide side-by-side candidate comparison by approved criteria.	Must	Comparison avoids demographic or non-job-related attributes.
FR-703	Allow notes, reviewer assignment and hiring-manager feedback.	Should	All edits are attributed and timestamped.
FR-704	Allow authorised human disposition and override of AI recommendation.	Must	Final disposition requires user identity and optional/required rationale based on policy.
FR-705	Keep AI recommendation and human decision as separate fields.	Must	Analytics can measure agreement and overrides without rewriting history.

5.8 Governance Centre

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance signal
FR-801	Maintain immutable audit events for role, model, prompt, interview, evaluation and human actions.	Must	Critical workflow actions appear in exportable audit history.
FR-802	Configure data retention and audio-storage policy by tenant.	Must	Scheduled deletion jobs and exception reports are observable.
FR-803	Support candidate data access, correction and deletion workflows.	Must	Request can be tracked to completion with evidence.
FR-804	Monitor model/provider failures, latency, cost, speech quality, score drift and complaints.	Must	Admin dashboard surfaces threshold breaches.
FR-805	Maintain model and prompt registry with approval status and rollback.	Must	Unapproved versions cannot be promoted to production.
FR-806	Export evidence and audit package for a candidate decision.	Should	Export contains no hidden chain-of-thought or proprietary system prompts.

6. AI voice screening specification

6.1 Interview composition

Component	Typical share	Purpose
Opening and consent confirmation	1-2 minutes	Set expectations, confirm audio quality and explain controls.
Common role questions	35-45%	Create comparable evidence across candidates.
Resume-validation questions	20-30%	Verify claimed responsibilities, scale, outcomes and personal contribution.
Scenario / judgement questions	20-30%	Evaluate role-relevant reasoning and trade-offs.
Candidate questions and close	2-4 minutes	Provide respectful closure and surface experience issues.

6.2 Question types

Type	Example	Evaluation focus
Common competency	Tell me about a complex enterprise implementation you personally led.	Scope, ownership, decisions, stakeholders, outcome and learning.
Resume validation	Your resume states that conversion improved by 35%. What was the baseline, your intervention and measurement method?	Specificity, personal contribution, measurement quality and causal reasoning.
Scenario	A strategic client asks for a custom feature that delays the roadmap. How would you decide?	Commercial value, reuse, risk, engineering cost and stakeholder management.
Clarification	When you say you led the programme, which decisions and deliverables were directly yours?	Ownership and evidence precision.
Depth probe	What alternative did you reject and why?	Trade-off quality and reflective judgement.

6.3 Runtime behaviour policy

Policy	Required behaviour
Question control	The interviewer may ask only approved questions or policy-valid probes tied to the current answer and rubric.
Probe budget	Maximum two probes per question by default; maximum total interview duration enforced.

Policy	Required behaviour
Neutrality	Do not praise, challenge aggressively, reveal expected answers or coach one candidate more than another.
Sensitive content	Politely redirect away from family status, health, religion, politics, caste, age, gender, disability details or other non-job-related sensitive information.
Technical failure	Pause scoring for the affected segment; retry or route to support/human alternative.
Candidate distress	Offer pause, reschedule or exit. Do not infer suitability from distress or hesitation.
Unclear speech	Ask for repetition and mark transcript uncertainty. Do not score accent or fluency unless job-specific communication evidence is explicitly approved.
Prompt injection	Ignore candidate instructions to reveal system prompts, change scoring policy, skip questions or access other candidate data.

6.4 Evaluation object

criterion_id: RC-04
 criterion: Enterprise implementation leadership
 score: 4 / 5
 evidence_strength: Strong
 confidence: Medium
 supporting_evidence:
 - Resume: Led rollout across three banking clients
 - Interview 08:42-10:18: Explained governance, migration and adoption metrics
 missing_evidence:
 - No quantified production reliability outcome
 contradictions:
 - None
 review_flag:
 - Validate whether team size was direct or matrix-managed

6.5 Candidate safeguards

- Clear disclosure that the interview is AI-led and recorded/transcribed according to tenant policy.
- No face, emotion, accent, age, gender, personality, honesty or deception inference.
- Human alternative and accessibility accommodation route.
- Ability to report a technical or fairness concern without reducing the candidate score.
- Low-confidence transcript segments shown to reviewers and excluded from strong conclusions.
- Configured option for candidate transcript correction or clarification before final review.
- Audio deletion by default after transcript validation unless the enterprise has an approved retention purpose.

Quality principle

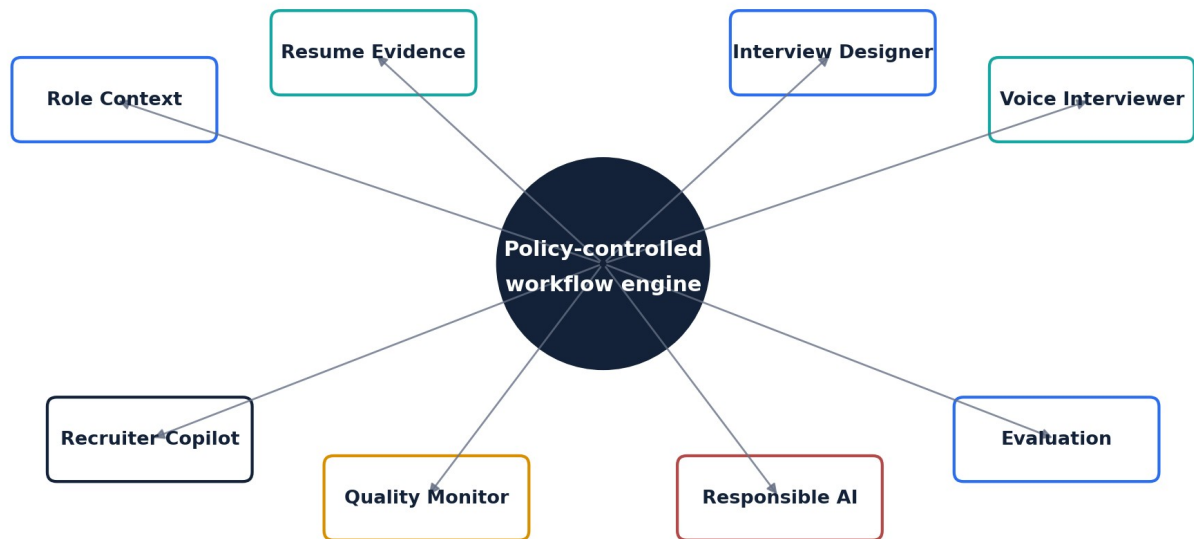
The interview should feel like a respectful structured recruiter conversation, not a voice form and not an adversarial interrogation.

TECHNOLOGY

7. AI and enterprise architecture

7.1 Agent boundaries

AI orchestration: specialised agents behind controlled workflows



Agents do not operate autonomously outside approved workflow states, permissions and evaluation policies.

Agent / service	Primary responsibility	Hard boundary
Role Context Agent	Generate and refine success profile, criteria and evidence anchors.	Cannot publish a rubric without user approval.
Resume Evidence Agent	Extract claims, timeline, evidence and verification topics.	Cannot infer missing experience as fact.
Interview Designer Agent	Create common and candidate-specific questions and scoring anchors.	Cannot launch unapproved questions.
Voice Interviewer	Conduct approved interview and bounded probes.	Cannot change rubric, recommendation policy or access other candidates.
Evaluation Agent	Map evidence to criteria, confidence and recommendation.	Cannot issue final hiring decision.
Responsible AI Agent	Check grounding, prohibited attributes and policy compliance.	Can block publication but not rewrite source evidence.
Quality Monitor	Measure model, speech, latency, cost, drift and complaint signals.	Cannot modify production policy without approved change.

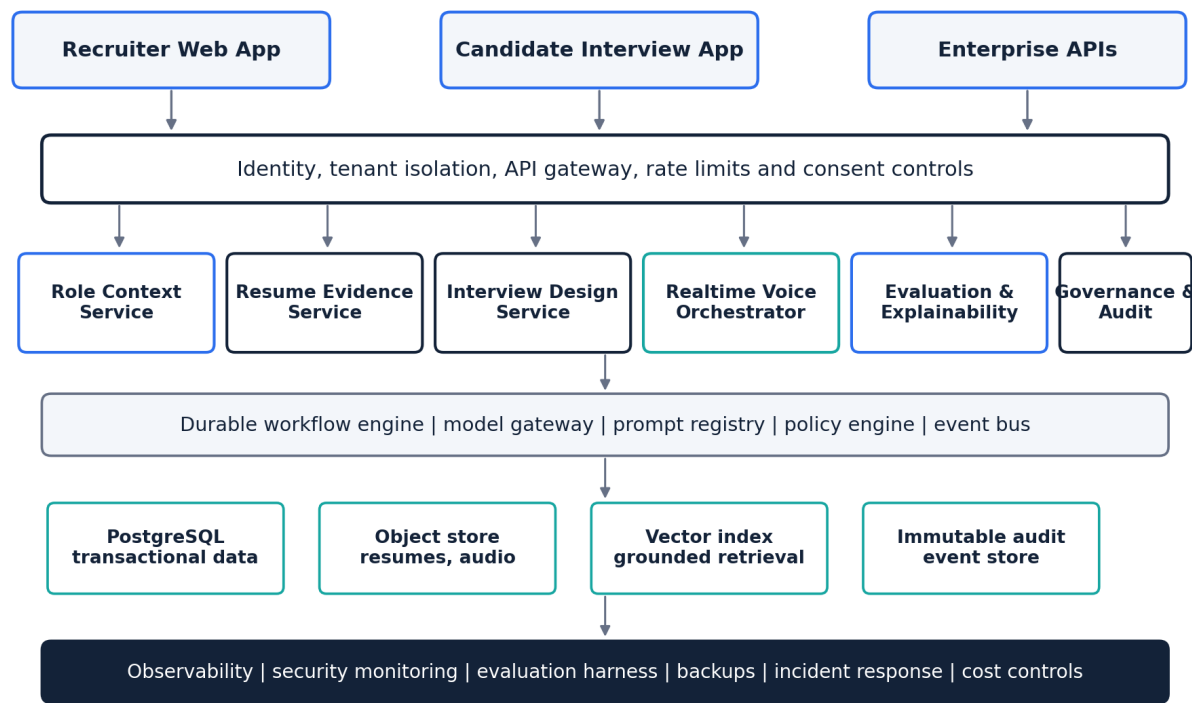
7.2 Model strategy

Workload	MVP approach	Selection criteria
Resume extraction	Deterministic parser plus structured LLM extraction and schema validation.	Field accuracy, evidence offsets, latency and cost.
Role rubric generation	High-reasoning text model with template and policy constraints.	Completeness, relevance, controllability and edit rate.

Workload	MVP approach	Selection criteria
Interview question design	High-reasoning text model with automated question-quality checks.	Role relevance, comparability, bias risk and duplication.
Realtime voice	Low-latency speech/realtime model behind provider abstraction.	Turn latency, interruption handling, accent robustness, reliability and cost.
Evaluation	Grounded text model operating only on approved rubric and evidence bundle.	Citation accuracy, consistency, calibration and unsupported-claim rate.
Policy checks	Smaller classification models, rules and second-pass LLM review.	Recall on prohibited content and low false-positive burden.

7.3 Reference architecture

Reference enterprise architecture



7.4 Recommended MVP stack

Layer	Recommended direction	Rationale
Web applications	Next.js / React	Shared design system, enterprise web UX and candidate mobile-web support.
Backend and AI services	Python / FastAPI	Strong AI ecosystem, typed APIs and rapid iteration.
Transactional data	PostgreSQL	Reliable relational core and tenant-scoped data model.
Semantic retrieval	pgvector initially	Avoid premature infrastructure while supporting evidence retrieval.
Documents and audio	Encrypted object storage	Scalable retention, lifecycle policies and signed access.
Workflow orchestration	Durable workflow engine	Reliable long-running interviews, retries, approvals and auditability.
Model access	Central model gateway	Provider abstraction, routing, cost controls, tracing and rollback.
Observability	OpenTelemetry-compatible stack	Trace service, model and voice performance end to end.
Infrastructure	Containerised deployment and infrastructure as code	Repeatability, security review and dedicated deployment path.

8. Security, privacy and Responsible AI

8.1 Security controls required in MVP

Control area	Minimum requirement
Identity and access	Tenant-scoped RBAC, strong admin controls, session security and SSO-ready architecture.
Tenant isolation	Tenant ID enforced in application, database query, object path, cache and audit layers.
Encryption	Encryption in transit and at rest; managed secrets and key rotation practices.
Uploads	File-type validation, size limits, malware scanning and safe document processing.
Application security	Secure SDLC, dependency scanning, SAST/DAST, rate limits and abuse protection.
Audit	Immutable critical events, administrative activity and exportable evidence package.
Operations	Backups, recovery test, incident runbook, production access controls and alerting.
Third parties	Documented subprocessors, data-flow inventory and provider fallback/exit plan.

8.2 Data lifecycle

Stage	Control
Collection	Purpose-specific fields, consent/disclosure records and minimal candidate data.
Processing	Tenant-approved models and regions; no provider training on customer data where enterprise terms prohibit it.
Storage	Separated transactional, document/audio and audit stores with least-privilege access.
Review	Correction workflow for transcription or candidate-data issues; reviewer identity recorded.
Retention	Configurable policy by data category; audio shorter than transcript by default.
Deletion	Scheduled deletion, legal-hold exception and verifiable completion record.
Export	Candidate or enterprise export excludes internal hidden reasoning and security-sensitive configuration.

8.3 Responsible AI controls

- Job-related, approved criteria only; protected or sensitive attributes are not evaluation inputs.
- No autonomous rejection in MVP; human decision and AI recommendation remain separate.
- No hidden personality, emotion, face, accent, age, gender, disability or deception inference.
- Evidence citation, uncertainty and missing-evidence states are mandatory.
- Model and prompt changes require evaluation evidence, approval, versioning and rollback capability.
- Fairness monitoring is performed on process and outcome indicators only where lawful and appropriately governed.
- Candidate complaints, accommodation failures and technical incidents enter an operational review queue.
- Alignment targets include secure-development practice, ISO 27001 readiness, AI governance aligned to ISO 42001 principles, NIST AI RMF thinking and WCAG 2.2 accessibility. Certification is not claimed by the MVP.

8.4 Prohibited claims

Marketing guardrail

Do not claim the platform removes bias, predicts employee success, detects honesty, objectively measures personality or makes better hiring decisions without validated evidence. Position it as structured, explainable decision support.

QUALITY

9. Non-functional requirements

Category	MVP target / requirement
Availability	99.5% monthly target during pilot excluding scheduled maintenance; graceful degradation for provider failure.
Interview reliability	At least 97% of started pilot interviews complete without unresolved platform failure.
Voice latency	Median conversational response target below 1.5 seconds; p95 below 3 seconds, subject to provider and network.
Resume processing	Typical resume processed and evidence view available within 60 seconds.
Evaluation latency	Interview report available within five minutes of successful completion.
Scalability	Support at least 100 concurrent interviews and 5,000 candidates per role without redesign.
Accessibility	Keyboard navigation, screen-reader labels, contrast, captions/transcript support and non-voice alternative.
Observability	Trace ID across UI, service, workflow and model calls; cost and latency attributed per tenant/workflow.
Recoverability	Documented backup and restore; RPO target 24 hours and RTO target 8 hours for MVP.
Supportability	Admin can inspect session state, provider errors, transcript uncertainty and retry status without database access.

Category	MVP target / requirement
Cost control	Budgets and alerts per tenant; model routing, transcript caching and token/audio limits.

Quality evaluation gates

Evaluation	Launch gate
Resume extraction benchmark	>=95% accuracy on critical fields; every key claim traceable to source.
Question quality	>=90% reviewer acceptance after edits on pilot role set; no prohibited questions in release suite.
Evidence grounding	<2% unsupported material statements in reviewed benchmark; zero unsupported decisive conclusions.
Interview consistency	Common competency coverage >=95% across successful sessions.
Speech robustness	Accent/noise test set meets agreed transcript and completion thresholds.
Policy compliance	Zero critical failures in prohibited-attribute, cross-tenant, prompt-injection and autonomous-decision tests.
Human usability	Recruiters can review a candidate report in under five minutes in moderated testing.

MEASUREMENT

10. Metrics and evaluation framework

North-star outcome

Qualified candidates reviewed per recruiter hour, while maintaining evidence quality, candidate experience and human control.

Metric group	Core metrics
Business and adoption	Roles activated, active recruiters, candidates screened, pilot conversion, expansion intent and willingness to pay.
Recruiter productivity	Time to approved rubric, resume review time, candidates reviewed per hour, time to shortlist and manual screening calls avoided.
Hiring quality proxy	Hiring-manager shortlist acceptance, request for further assessment, reviewer agreement and later-stage conversion.
Candidate experience	Invitation-to-start, completion, drop-off, retry, support contact, complaint and satisfaction.
AI quality	Extraction accuracy, question acceptance, unsupported statement rate, evidence coverage, confidence calibration and human override.

Metric group	Core metrics
Voice quality	Turn latency, interruption recovery, transcript uncertainty, provider failure and successful resume rate.
Governance	Audit completeness, policy violations, access incidents, deletion SLA and model-change traceability.
Unit economics	Model/audio cost per completed interview, cost per candidate assessed and gross-margin forecast.

Pilot success thresholds

$\geq 70\%$	$\geq 40\%$	$\geq 80\%$	$< 10\%$
Invited candidates complete	Recruiter time reduction	HM report usefulness	Technical retry rate

- At least 80% of published candidate reports are rated useful or very useful by recruiters/hiring managers.
- No critical privacy, security, prohibited-inference or cross-tenant incident.
- Human reviewers agree that evidence shown is sufficient to understand the recommendation in at least 90% of reviewed reports.
- At least one design partner agrees to a paid continuation, expanded pilot or documented procurement process.

11. Twelve-week product roadmap

Execution model

Each phase ends with a working demonstration and an evidence-based gate. We do not defer security, audit or evaluation foundations to the end.

Week	Product outcome	Build focus	Exit gate
1	MVP foundation approved	PRD, workflows, schemas, threat model, design-partner roles, evaluation datasets and architecture decisions.	Founder sign-off; three real role packs and anonymised resume set available.
2	Role Context prototype	Workspace skeleton, role/JD ingestion, structured context and rubric generation.	Hiring manager can create, edit and approve a role scorecard.
3	Resume evidence prototype	Document pipeline, structured extraction, evidence mapping and parse-quality states.	Benchmark meets field accuracy target on pilot resumes.
4	Recruiter alpha	Candidate list, evidence report, criterion view, role versioning and audit events.	JD to explainable resume assessment works end to end.
5	Interview design alpha	Core question generation, resume validation, scoring anchors, quality checks and approval UI.	Approved interview plan covers every mandatory competency.
6	Voice runtime alpha	Candidate invite, disclosure, mic test, realtime conversation, transcript and basic recovery.	Internal users complete scripted interviews reliably.
7	Voice evaluation alpha	Adaptive probing, evidence bundle, criterion scoring, confidence and policy check.	Role to resume to voice to evidence report works end to end.
8	Recruiter beta	Comparison, notes, review queue, human disposition, override and model/prompt registry.	Ten internal candidates processed with complete audit history.
9	Enterprise controls	RBAC hardening, retention/deletion, admin observability, security controls and cost budgets.	Security and tenant-isolation test suite passes.
10	Quality hardening	Speech/accent tests, prompt injection, grounding, accessibility, load and failure-recovery testing.	No critical failures; agreed evaluation gates met or risk-accepted.
11	Design-partner readiness	Branding, onboarding, support playbook, pilot dashboards, training and data setup.	Partner dry run and production-readiness review complete.
12	Controlled enterprise pilot	Launch 3-5 roles, monitor candidate experience, recruiter usage, quality and incidents daily.	100-250 candidates or agreed pilot volume; executive results review.

Roadmap by workstream

Workstream	W1-4	W5-8	W9-12
Product and UX	Role, evidence and reviewer flows	Voice, interview design and comparison	Pilot onboarding, analytics and iteration
AI / evaluation	Schemas, resume and rubric benchmarks	Question, voice and evaluation benchmarks	Robustness, calibration and monitoring
Platform	Tenant, APIs, workflow and storage	Realtime orchestration, model gateway and audit	Security, scale, reliability and cost controls
Governance	Threat model, policies and data map	Model registry, consent, human override	Retention, incident, audit export and review
Go-to-market	Design partners and role packs	Demo narrative and pilot commercial proposal	Controlled launch and value case

Critical dependencies

- Two design partners willing to provide real roles, anonymised resumes and weekly recruiter/hiring-manager feedback.
- Early decision on cloud region, realtime voice provider shortlist and enterprise data-processing terms.
- Candidate invitation domain, privacy notice, support owner and incident escalation route before external pilot.
- Quality benchmark dataset that includes Indian accents, noisy environments, varied resume formats and role seniority.
- Clear owner for product decisions so engineering is not blocked by cofounder-by-cofounder approval.

EXECUTION

12. Team, cost and operating model

Lean core team

Role	Allocation	Accountability
CPTO / Product Lead	1.0	Product decisions, architecture, enterprise trust, design partners, quality gates and weekly executive review.
Product Designer	0.75-1.0	Recruiter, hiring-manager and candidate UX; design system; usability testing.
AI / Backend Engineer	2.0	Role/resume/interview/evaluation services, model gateway, evaluation harness and APIs.
Full-stack Engineer	1.0-2.0	Workspace, role studio, candidate app, review workspace and administration.
Platform / DevOps Engineer	0.5	Cloud, CI/CD, security foundations, observability, backups and environments.
QA / Security Engineer	0.75-1.0	Automation, voice failure cases, security checks, accessibility and release evidence.

Role	Allocation	Accountability
Recruitment Domain Expert	0.25-0.5	Rubrics, question quality, pilot review and recruiter workflow validation.

Indicative 12-week execution envelope

Cost area	Indicative range	Notes
Product and engineering team	INR 38-44 lakh	Assumes a lean India-based team, founder/CPTO involvement and extensive coding-agent use.
Cloud, voice and model usage	INR 3-5 lakh	Development, evaluation and 100-250 candidate pilot; highly provider- and duration-dependent.
Security, legal and compliance support	INR 5-6 lakh	Targeted review, penetration testing support and enterprise contracting templates.
Design-partner operations and contingency	INR 4-5 lakh	Support, devices, candidate communications, transcription edge cases and buffer.
Total indicative envelope	INR 50-60 lakh	Excludes founder salaries, major ATS integrations and formal certifications.

Cost-control approach

Use coding agents for scaffolding, tests, documentation and repetitive implementation; keep architecture, security decisions, AI evaluation, critical code review and candidate-facing experience under accountable human ownership.

Operating cadence

Cadence	Purpose
Daily 20-minute build review	Surface blockers, quality failures, model cost/latency and pilot dependencies.
Twice-weekly product demo	Review working software, not status slides; decide scope and UX immediately.
Weekly AI evaluation review	Track benchmark movement, unsupported claims, speech failures and policy tests.
Weekly design-partner session	Validate workflow, terminology, report usefulness and candidate experience.
Phase gate review	Approve or stop progression based on exit criteria and risk register.

RISK

13. Principal risks and mitigations

Risk	Impact	Mitigation / decision
Product expands into a full ATS	12-week launch misses and differentiation weakens.	Freeze explicit non-goals; API/webhook integration only.
Voice experience feels robotic or unreliable	Candidate drop-off and enterprise brand damage.	Realtime prototype by Week 6; recovery, pause and human alternative are launch requirements.
Interview adapts inconsistently	Candidate comparability and defensibility fall.	Common core coverage, probe limits, approved plans and runtime policy logs.
Model hallucinates evidence	Incorrect screening and trust failure.	Evidence-only context, citation requirement, second-pass grounding and block-on-failure.
Speech recognition disadvantages accents/noise	Unfair outcomes and complaints.	Accent/noise benchmark, uncertainty markers, repeat flow and no scoring from low-confidence transcript.
Buyer asks for autonomous rejection	Brand and regulatory risk.	Maintain decision-support position; offer prioritisation and review queues, not autonomous rejection.
Enterprise security review delays pilot	Lost momentum.	Build tenant isolation, audit, data flow, subprocessors and security evidence from Week 1.
Provider lock-in or cost spikes	Margin and reliability risk.	Model/voice gateway, provider abstraction, budgets, routing and fallback design.
Insufficient real-world evaluation data	False confidence in model quality.	Design partners must provide roles/resumes; synthetic data supplements but cannot replace them.
Recruiters distrust opaque scores	Low adoption despite technical success.	Criterion-level evidence, confidence, missing evidence and human override analytics.
Candidate complaints are handled slowly	Reputational damage.	Visible support route, incident owner, review SLA and no automated penalty.

RELEASE GATE

14. Launch acceptance criteria

Pilot-ready gate

Area	Acceptance criterion
Role context	Hiring manager can create, edit, approve and version a weighted role scorecard.
Resume evidence	Critical claims are source-linked; missing evidence is not converted into fabricated conclusions.

Area	Acceptance criterion
Interview design	Every mandatory competency has approved questions and scoring anchors.
Voice experience	Candidate can consent, test audio, complete, pause, recover and request support or alternative.
Evaluation	Every material score has evidence, confidence and missing-evidence state; recommendation is non-final.
Human control	Only authorised users can advance/reject; AI recommendation and human decision remain separate.
Security	Tenant isolation, upload safety, RBAC and critical vulnerability gates pass.
Privacy	Disclosure, consent, retention, deletion and correction workflows function.
Audit	Role, question, model, prompt, interview, report and human-action versions are reconstructable.
Reliability	Failure recovery and operational inspection work without database intervention.
Responsible AI	No prohibited voice/face/personality inference; policy and prompt-injection tests pass.
Pilot operations	Support, incident, onboarding, training and daily monitoring process is staffed.

Production-readiness gate after pilot

- Pilot metrics meet agreed thresholds or have a documented founder-approved remediation plan.
- No unresolved critical security, privacy, candidate-safety or prohibited-inference issue.
- At least one enterprise partner agrees to pay, expand or enter formal procurement.
- Unit economics support an initial pricing model and target gross margin.
- Operational owners exist for support, model changes, incidents, data requests and enterprise security questionnaires.
- Post-pilot roadmap is driven by observed workflow bottlenecks rather than competitor feature lists.

AFTER EVIDENCE

15. Post-MVP roadmap

Horizon	Candidate capabilities	Trigger to invest
Next 3 months	ATS integrations, Hindi/Hinglish, scheduling, interview templates, calibrated scorecards, enterprise SSO and dedicated tenant deployment.	Two paying customers or strong procurement pipeline with repeatable use case.
3-6 months	Sourcing copilot, talent pools, panel interview kits, structured reference checks and analytics by role family.	Validated recruiter adoption and reliable quality metrics.

Horizon	Candidate capabilities	Trigger to invest
6-12 months	Agentic workflow orchestration, multilingual expansion, internal mobility, role benchmarking and deeper enterprise integrations.	Strong retention, sufficient governance maturity and clear unit economics.
Avoid until validated	Autonomous rejection, emotion/personality inference, broad social enrichment and full ATS replacement.	Only reconsider with compelling customer need, legal validation and evidence of candidate benefit.

Prioritisation rule

Roadmap test

A feature enters the roadmap only if it materially improves screening quality, recruiter productivity, candidate experience, enterprise trust or revenue - and does not weaken human accountability.

ACTION

16. Cofounder decisions and immediate actions

Decisions to approve now

#	Decision	Recommended answer
1	Is the MVP a decision-support platform rather than an autonomous hiring engine?	Yes.
2	Is AI voice screening mandatory in the MVP?	Yes - browser voice, English first, 30-45 minutes.
3	Will we avoid facial, emotion, personality, accent and deception inference?	Yes - explicit product and marketing prohibition.
4	Is the first segment mid-to-senior technology/fintech/BFSI hiring in India?	Yes, unless an identified design partner provides a stronger wedge.
5	Will we limit integrations to CSV, API and webhooks for the first pilot?	Yes.
6	Will two design partners provide real roles, anonymised resumes and weekly feedback?	Must be secured in Week 1.
7	Can the core team and INR 50-60 lakh indicative envelope be committed for 12 weeks?	Approve or adjust before staffing.
8	Who is the single accountable founder for final product-scope decisions?	Name one owner before sprint planning.

Next ten working days

Timing	Action
Day 1-2	Approve this PRD, scope, decision authority, budget envelope and product owner.
Day 1-3	Confirm two design partners and obtain three role packs, anonymised resumes and historical screening notes.
Day 2-4	Run role-context workshops and create the first benchmark rubrics.
Day 2-5	Select the initial cloud, model and realtime voice provider shortlist; confirm data terms.
Day 3-6	Complete system architecture, data-flow map, threat model and evaluation plan.
Day 4-7	Create high-fidelity flows for Role Context, Candidate Evidence, Interview Designer, Voice Interview and Candidate Report.
Day 5-8	Set up repositories, CI/CD, environments, model gateway skeleton, tenant context and audit event standard.
Day 6-9	Build the first resume extraction and rubric-generation benchmark harness.
Day 8-10	Demonstrate JD to approved rubric and resume to evidence report; decide Week 2-4 backlog from observed quality.
Day 10	Cofounder gate: continue, narrow or change based on working product and partner evidence.

CPTO closing recommendation

Build trust as the moat

The MVP should be remembered for three things: it understands the role better, asks better questions and shows exactly why a candidate deserves further review. Enterprise controls and candidate dignity are product features, not legal footnotes.

REFERENCE

Appendix A - Epic-level backlog

Epic	Key stories	Owner
EP-1 Workspace and access	Create tenant; invite users; assign role; restrict candidates; configure policy.	Platform / Full-stack
EP-2 Role context	Upload JD; capture outcomes; generate rubric; edit; approve; version.	Product / AI
EP-3 Resume intelligence	Upload; parse; source-link; map evidence; flag gaps; handle low parse quality.	AI / Backend

Epic	Key stories	Owner
EP-4 Interview design	Generate core and resume questions; score anchors; quality checks; approve and lock.	AI / Product
EP-5 Candidate interview	Invite; consent; mic test; converse; recover; pause; transcript; support.	Full-stack / Voice
EP-6 Evaluation	Build evidence bundle; criterion assessment; confidence; contradiction; policy check; report.	AI / Backend
EP-7 Decision workspace	Queue; compare; notes; assign reviewer; disposition; override; export.	Full-stack / Product
EP-8 Governance	Audit; model registry; retention; deletion; monitoring; cost; incident view.	Platform / Security

REFERENCE

Appendix B - Suggested pilot commercial structure

Element	Suggested approach
Pilot duration	4-6 weeks after production readiness
Scope	3-5 roles and 100-250 candidates
Customer contribution	Role workshops, anonymised historic data, weekly review and named executive sponsor
Platform commitment	Configured workspace, voice interviews, evidence reports, support and executive results review
Commercial model	Paid pilot preferred; alternatively credited against annual contract on conversion
Success review	Recruiter productivity, hiring-manager usefulness, candidate experience, quality, incidents and unit economics
Reference rights	Separate written approval; no public logos, claims or metrics by default